

Tuesday, August 9

Matthew was awake by 7:15. Cheryl and I sat together with him and talked about family, parents and childraising. Peter woke at 8:30. We ate breakfast. Peter practised cello from 9:10 - 9:40. After, Cheryl sewed and I put on the last three boards of gyproc. Things are finally ready to be organized down there.

Dinner finished by 12:30. We left the house with the dishes soaking in the sink. Cheryl went to her mother's for a perm. Peter went to his pedal-pusher's class. Matthew and I went to Grandma Hedlin's. She received news from her doctor that she was physically as young as someone approaching 70. She is very alert and talked about all the news: Uncle Al and Aunt Isabel may stay in Thailand another three months, Uncle Ed needs bifocals, Katherine and Graham's daughter Meagan is as dark as he, much to Graham's pleasure, Karen spends two days a week in her daughter's day care, the rest of the time in Summer School and Uncle Alan is back in the hospital with severe hemorrhaging from his recent surgery. We left at 2:45 for Peter. Matthew walked enough to impress her and played hide and seek and peek-a-boo while she laughed.

Peter enjoys the biking lessons. The policeman had been there.

As I put Peter's bike in the back seat he said, "Dad, I want to tell you some very important rules. The police says I need a bell and a license."

He emphasized bell and license as if we have chosen to disregard the only two things in his life of any importance.

Cheryl's hair was curly. She seemed happy with it. We sat in the living room long enough to watch Matthew walk with no help. Help us. When we got home nearing 4 Matthew and Peter lay down for short rests. Cheryl and I went to the basement and cleaned. By 4:30 Matthew was awake. Cheryl went up to get him. He straddled her sewing machine cover like a horse and bounced on it.

We ate scrambled eggs for supper. Peter had hoped for spaghetti. We arranged to take him to the dump.

After supper we went downstairs and moved some of my things - desk and books. The boys were wild in Matthew's playpen. We cleaned up at 7 and loaded the gyproc scraps in the trunk. On the freeway we passed Cheryl's parents, stopped, rerouted ourselves to Archie Campbell's corn fields. The gyproc went into Cheryl's parents garbage. We stopped at the DQ on 8th. Peter ordered a Butterscotch "Barfait", Cheryl and her mom Busterbars, Cheryl's dad a cone, me a cone and Matthew a spoon. We stopped by the Skarsgard grandparents, chatted from the car, went by Cheryl's parents to get the boys and went home. They were tired. They bathed. Peter listened to his tape. We decided to put Matthew down with no ceremony, no bum-patting. Difficult. Didn't work. Cheryl bathed and I stood by the crib. Each time he got up I told him to lie down. He cried, gripped the dowels, collapsed slowly but would raise himself again, put his hands on my chest, lean his head against my stomach, then collapse slowly like before. Finally he lay still, sighed, reversed himself then slept.